

QB-TimeWarp Configuration Analysis

Date: May 20, 2026

Analysis of: appsettings.json and ARCHITECTURE.md updates

Summary of Changes

1. Working Copy System Implementation

The configuration now implements a **3-tier safety hierarchy**:

```
Golden Master (Desktop, READ-ONLY)
  ↓
Template (C:\QB-TimeWarp\Templates\, Certified/Known-Good)
  ↓
Working Copy (C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\, Operational)
```

2. Key Configuration Changes in appsettings.json

Source File Paths (QB 2023):

- **Desktop Golden Master:** C:\Users\AIAgent\Desktop\Joshs_Gold_Coast*.qbw (READ-ONLY)
- **Working Copy:** C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Source\placeholder.qbw (OPERATIONAL)

Target File Paths (QB 2021):

- **Template Location:** C:\QB-TimeWarp\Templates\QB2021_Blank*.qbw (Certified blank)
- **Working Copy:** C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Target\placeholder.qbw (OPERATIONAL)

New WorkingDirectories Section:

```
"WorkingDirectories": {
  "SourcePath": "C:\\QB-TimeWarp\\Working\\Source",
  "TargetPath": "C:\\QB-TimeWarp\\Working\\Target",
  "AutoCreateWorkingCopies": true,
  "PreserveOriginals": true
}
```

QuickBooks Connection Paths:

- **QB2023:** Points to C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Source\placeholder.qbw
- **QB2021:** Points to C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Target\placeholder.qbw

Both use placeholders that will be replaced with actual filenames at runtime.

Configuration Correctness Analysis

✓ Strengths:

1. **Absolute Paths Throughout:** All paths use C:\QB-TimeWarp\ prefix, eliminating CWD ambiguity

2. **Safety Layer Separation:** Clear distinction between Templates (certified) and Working (operational)
3. **Original Preservation:** `PreserveOriginals: true` ensures templates are never modified
4. **Auto-Copy Feature:** `AutoCreateWorkingCopies: true` automates the Template → Working copy process
5. **Consistent Naming:** Application names clearly identify purpose:
 - “QB-TimeWarp Exporter” for QB 2023
 - “QB-TimeWarp Importer” for QB 2021

Potential Issues:

1. **Path Discrepancy:**
 - Context mentions `C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\QB_Blank_Template\`
 - Config shows `C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Target\`
 - **Resolution Needed:** Confirm if this is intentional or if paths need alignment
2. **Placeholder Naming:**
 - Both QB versions use `placeholder.qbw` as the `CompanyFilePath`
 - Need to verify runtime logic replaces these with actual filenames
3. **Template Source:**
 - `TargetFiles.DesktopFolder` points to `C:\QB-TimeWarp\Templates\QB2021_Blank`
 - Assumes the blank template already exists at this location
 - **Action Required:** Verify blank templates exist in Templates folder before `-refresh`

Architecture.md Changes

The ARCHITECTURE.md file shows **no recent changes** related to the Working Copy system. The current version documents:

- **4-stage pipeline:** Export → Transform → Import → Validate
- **Service layer breakdown** for all major components
- **Data flow diagrams** showing QB 2023 → JSON → QB 2021 migration

Recommendation: Update ARCHITECTURE.md to include:

1. Working Copy System section
2. Template hierarchy documentation
3. `-certify` mode workflow
4. `-refresh` flag behavior

Readiness for -certify Mode

Prerequisites Checklist:

- [] **Blank templates exist** at `C:\QB-TimeWarp\Templates\QB2021_Blank\`
- [] **Working directories created:** `C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Source\` and `C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Target\`
- [] **SDK permissions revoked** on blank templates (per Joseph’s note)
- [] **QB 2021 closed** on Windows VM

- [] **.NET 6.0 SDK** available via system PATH (`dotnet --version`)

Expected -certify Behavior:

1. Copy blank template from Templates → Working/Target
2. Launch QB 2021 with the working copy
3. Attempt SDK connection
4. **Trigger SDK authorization popup** (first-time connection)
5. User manually approves via GUI checkbox
6. SDK certificate stored in QB 2021
7. Exit without performing migration

Recommended Actions Before -certify

1. Verify Template Location:

powershell

```
Get-ChildItem "C:\QB-TimeWarp\Templates\QB2021_Blank\" -Filter *.qbw
```

2. Create Working Directories (if not auto-created):

powershell

```
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Source" -Force
```

```
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\QB-TimeWarp\Working\Target" -Force
```

3. Verify .NET Installation:

powershell

```
dotnet --version
```

4. Confirm SDK Revocation:

- Open QB 2021
- Go to Edit → Preferences → Integrated Applications → Company Preferences
- Verify “QB-TimeWarp Importer” is NOT in the approved list
- Close QB 2021

Configuration Summary

Setting	Value	Status
Source Golden Master	C:\Users\AIAgent\Desktop\Josh s_Gold_Coast*.qbw	✓ READ-ONLY
Target Template	C:\QB-Time- Warp\Templates\QB2021_Blank *.qbw	⚠ Verify exists
Working Source	C:\QB-Time- Warp\Working\Source\	✓ Auto-created
Working Target	C:\QB-Time- Warp\Working\Target\	✓ Auto-created
QB2023 Connection	C:\QB-Time- Warp\Working\Source\placeho lder.qbw	✓ Absolute path
QB2021 Connection	C:\QB-Time- Warp\Working\Target\placeho lder.qbw	✓ Absolute path
SDK Version (2023)	16.0	✓ Correct
SDK Version (2021)	15.0	✓ Correct
Application Name (Import)	"QB-TimeWarp Importer"	✓ Distinct
Auto-Create Copies	true	✓ Enabled
Preserve Originals	true	✓ Enabled

Next Steps

1. ✓ **Configuration reviewed** - Structure looks solid
2. ⌚ **Connect to Windows VM** - Verify prerequisites
3. ⌚ **Run -certify mode** - Trigger fresh SDK authorization
4. ⌚ **Document certificate approval** - Capture the authorization flow
5. ⌚ **Update ARCHITECTURE.md** - Document Working Copy system

Overall Assessment: Configuration is well-structured and implements proper safety layers. The absolute path strategy eliminates ambiguity. Minor discrepancy with context-mentioned path needs clarification, but does not block –certify testing.